GOSKOM

Государственный комитет по делам Союза · State Committee for Union Affairs

FOREGROUND GUIDE

Changes to the rules of procedure, documentation and general flow of committee. Where this guide and the Background Guide disagree, this guide governs.

15 January 1990

FROM THE CHAIR

HELLO, DELEGATES

I am **Guru Charan Sivakumar**. (Everyone say boo, Sairam Dhal.)

So this "foreground guide" (haha funny name, courtesy of Sairam Dhal) is just intended to clarify a bunch of changes (bug fixes, as the dev in me wants to call them) to the rules of procedure, the documentation, and the general flow and intent behind committee. They are changes that I will be making, and that might feel unfamiliar to you if you assumed the committee would be working off of exactly what the BG outlined.

Do read through this document thoroughly, as there are pretty significant changes to how **literally everything** will be working.

THIS GUIDE IS NOT	THIS GUIDE IS
Anything substantive about the actual agenda	Purely procedural
Anything about the situation on the ground	A way to manage your expectations regarding committee
Anything about the discussions to be had in committee	

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

BACKGROUND GUIDE	FOREGROUND GUIDE	
~~Press Releases~~	DROPPED	No press releases of any form
~~Political Resolution, voted upon~~	REPLACED	Joint Resolution, signed not voted
~~Military Directive~~	REPLACED	Action Brief, one per person per day
~~Motion to engage in a substantive intervention~~	DROPPED	
Unmoderated consultations	TRIAL	Five minutes, once per day
~~Motion to move into voting~~	REPLACED	Closure of debate, or a motion to table
Electronic devices	BANNED	From the start of Day 1
Opening statements	NEW	One motion, at the very start of Day 1 only
Simulation clock	NEW	One real hour is about half a simulated day

PART I · DOCUMENTATION

JOINT RESOLUTIONS

01

No more press releases

We are no longer going to be doing any form of press releases.

02

Political Resolutions become Joint Resolutions

Political resolutions will now be replaced with something called **"Joint Resolutions"** (your vice chair hates the abbreviation).

I have dropped the word "political" **intentionally**. These are **no longer going to be voted upon**, unlike what the BG mentions.

BEFORE THE CHANGE

01	02	03	04	05
Open agenda item	Debate, and anything else you want here	Delegates close the agenda	Delegates propose draft resolutions	~~First to pass by a 2/3 majority wins the agenda~~

Then go home, or open another agenda, and the loop continues.

This simplifies a complex set of ROP, including a rule for deciding which draft is voted on first. Ask your vice chairs if you are curious. It also ignores the other forms of documentation.

AFTER THE CHANGE

01	02	03	04	05
Open agenda	Debate and what not	Delegates move into closure of debate	**Submit your Joint Resolutions**	Next item, or go home if you want idk bro

NO VOTING

Every JR submission is simply collected by us and sent on the WhatsApp group for everyone to see.

03

How a JR works

1 JRs are **not voted upon**.

2 They **will** carry signatures from the delegates supporting them.

3 Each JR has **no author, no co-author, no special status**. Everyone who supports it just signs, with their allotment next to the signature.

4 **Each person may sign only one JR**, within a specific agenda item.

Other than that, there is **no real limit on JRs**.

PART I · DOCUMENTATION

ACTION BRIEFS

We will also be dropping the idea of **"Military Directives"**. Instead we introduce another avenue for taking actions, called the **Action Brief**.

THE RULE

One action brief per person, per day.

Use them wisely. Your one chance can go towards a **joint action** with other members of the committee, or an **individual action**. Whether joint or individual doesn't matter: you only get **one total**.

04

When you can submit

The fun part about action briefs: as soon as committee starts in the morning we will announce **"we will now be taking action briefs."** From that moment until the very end of the day, when we say **"committee has been adjourned, go home,"** you can submit your one action brief of the day.

Think about the flow of committee, and the fact that you can submit your action brief **whenever you want**.

05

Formats

Both formats are extremely simple.

JOINT RESOLUTION

DATE
In-committee date. Please don't put 2026.

GOALS OF THIS JR
What the signatories are working towards

PREAMBLES
Referencing any documents that should be brought up as context

WHY THESE GOALS
The reasoning behind them

HOW THESE GOALS WILL BE ACHIEVED
The route from here to there

SIGNATURE · ALLOTMENT | SIGNATURE · ALLOTMENT | SIGNATURE · ALLOTMENT

ACTION BRIEF

WHAT ACTION
The thing you want to do

WHY
The reason for doing it

HOW
The mechanics of it

FEASIBILITY
Prove it is something actually feasible or doable by your allotment

PART II · CONDITIONS OF THE ROOM

DEVICES, CLOCK & MOTIONS

YOU WANT TO READ THIS

No electronic devices inside committee.

As of right now we are not allowing use of **any electronic devices** inside the committee, from the start of committee on Day 1 itself. Have fun.

YOU WANT TO READ THIS 2

Rules of procedure start at 8:15. No exceptions.

I don't know what your experience with events or MUNs is, but I am not going to be delaying the start of committee. I will explain the rules of procedure (which I think everyone should attend, given how new it is and how complicated it can look) as quickly as possible, and then begin committee proceedings. If the event start time is X (which I'm told is 8 am?), I am starting the rules of procedure at **8:15** with no exceptions. (See, I'm so nice, I'm giving y'all 15 minutes.) As soon as that is over, committee will start.

06

Timeline

COMMITTEE BEGINS

05:00

15 January 1990

Whenever committee starts on Day 1 marks 5am

1 hour in real life approx = half a day in simulation →

COMMITTEE ENDS

23:00

20 January 1990

Reached at 5:30 in real life, at the end of committee on Day 1

We will use the projector or a laptop screen to **display the simulation world time and date at all points**.

07

Motions

DROPPED	**Substantive intervention**	The motion to engage in a substantive intervention is gone.
ACCEPTED	**Moderated consultations and unmoderated caucus**	I will be entertaining both of these motions.
ON TRIAL	**Unmoderated consultations**	A five minute trial run, **once per day**. If the test turns into a "fish market" for lack of a better word, it will not be allowed at all. If it goes well, I will accept unmoderated consultations as motions from there on.
DAY 1 ONLY	**Opening statements**	On Day 1 alone, at the very beginning of committee, I will be doing a single opening statement motion, where delegates might get a chance to make opening statements. It happens only once, and never again after that. If that information helps you, good for you.

PART III · REWRITTEN SECTIONS OF THE BG

REWRITTEN SECTIONS OF THE BG

If you haven't read the BG yet and are reading this, it saves you some time. Below are full sections of the BG, edited to match the new changes. Read the BG as normal, and when you reach the appropriate sections, read them from here instead. They all come from Section 15, Committee Mandate and Rules of Procedure. The Mandate itself, and every other section of the BG, stand as written.

§15

What you can do

IF YOU WANT TO...	THEN YOU USE...
Put a new issue before the committee	A motion to set an agenda.
Negotiate and lobby privately	A motion to move into unmoderated caucus, with a time limit specified.
Put a text on the record	Submit a Joint Resolution when the committee moves into closure of debate, and collect signatures. There is no vote.
Stop a debate going nowhere	Raise a motion to move into closure of debate, which collects the Joint Resolutions and closes the agenda, or a motion to table, which pauses the agenda with no Joint Resolutions taken.
Order military or security action	Submit an Action Brief. You get one per day.
Explain your stance in your own style	Submit a Position Paper, Statement of Intent or Substantive/Analysis Chit. These are not marked.

The press release row of the BG table is gone, because press releases are gone.

§15

How the committee moves

An issue enters the committee only after it has been temporarily adopted as an Agenda Item by motion. Once adopted, it is debated, and delegates may do anything else they find useful in the meantime. When the committee wants to proceed, it has two options. A **motion to move into closure of debate** collects all Joint Resolutions and then closes the agenda: the committee will no longer discuss that agenda. A **motion to table** takes no Joint Resolutions: the agenda is put aside, paused, and can be resumed later if the committee wants to.

Joint Resolutions are not voted upon. We simply collect every submission and send it on the WhatsApp group for everyone to see. The committee then moves to the next item, or goes home. This design still lets the committee tackle several issues in turn, since no single document could cover a territory this large.

§15

Individual and collective powers

Collective power no longer lives in resolutions that the committee adopts, because the committee does not adopt anything. It lives in **Joint Resolutions**: groups of delegates signing, with their allotments next to their signatures, to say that they will do their best to work towards a stated goal. A JR has no author, no co-author and no special status, and each person may sign only one JR within an Agenda Item.

Individual power is still deliberately modest. You exercise it through what you say in the room while representing your portfolio, and through your **one Action Brief per day**, which may be a joint action or an individual one, but never both. The personal documents described below are not marked.

On the question of which portfolios may submit which documents, we will not set limits by office. We will judge plausibility in the light of the office you hold and the situation in committee. An Action Brief submitted by someone with no plausible authority over troops is likely to be taken as what it is: a waste of paper.

§15

Voting

There is no voting on Joint Resolutions. The BG's special majority and second vote no longer apply to them, and an agenda is no longer tabled because papers fail: it is tabled only by a motion to table. What a JR carries is its signatures, and nothing else: even a JR on a question as grave as disbanding the USSR is only a promise made by the people who signed it.

§15

Types of motions

This committee does not use various modes of debate, so the motions available are the following.

KEPT	**Motion to set an agenda** As soon as the motion passes, the committee moves to moderated consultations.
KEPT	**Motion to move into unmoderated caucus** The time limit is to be specified in the motion.
CHANGED	**Motion to move into closure of debate** Replaces the motion to move into voting. All Joint Resolutions are collected and then the agenda is closed: the committee will no longer discuss that agenda or motion.
NEW	**Motion to table** No Joint Resolutions are taken. The agenda is put aside, paused, and can be resumed later if the committee wants to.
TRIAL	**Unmoderated consultations** A five minute trial run, once per day. If the test turns into a "fish market" for lack of a better word, it will not be allowed at all. If it goes well, I will accept unmoderated consultations as motions from there on.
NEW	**Opening statements** One motion, at the very beginning of committee on Day 1 only, where delegates might get a chance to make opening statements.
REMOVED	**Motion to engage in a substantive intervention** The Board will not be guiding the committee along any path, cryptic or otherwise.

§15

Types of documentation

The committee shall produce two forms of documentation. The BG's International Press Release and Military Directive are discontinued.

JOINT RESOLUTION

A **Joint Resolution** is a formal statement of intent, signed by the delegates who support it, setting out a goal and how it will be pursued. It is not passed by the committee. It is a commitment by its signatories to do their best to work towards that goal. Format: the in-committee date, then the goals of the JR, then preambles referencing any documents that should be brought up as context, then why these goals, then how they will be achieved, then signatures with allotments.

ACTION BRIEF

An **Action Brief** is the single action you take in a day, on your own or with other members of the committee. Format: what the action is, why, how, and proof that it is feasible for your allotment. You may submit it at any point between the announcement "we will now be taking action briefs" in the morning and "committee has been adjourned" at the end of the day.

PERSONAL DOCUMENTS

Apart from these, personal documentation is accepted. Please note that these documents will not be marked. They only serve as a means of explaining your stance better, and submitting any of them is not mandatory (trust the Board, it may do more harm than good). There is no format for these documents. Permitted forms include a Position Paper, a Statement of Intent, and a Substantive/Analysis Chit.

All the best. I hope this will be fun. If it isn't, you can contact **Sairam Dhal** and **Hemanya Saini**.

"you have met me at a very chinese time of my life"

Guru Charan Sivakumar
Chairperson, GOSKOM

If you are Sairam or Saini, click this. If you're not, don't. *(Curiosity makes the cat laugh at you.)*

i thank my vice chairs for giving me the opportunity to work on my anger issues